

blend the packages that related to the medical industry can be downloaded from their repositories (these packages are listed at <http://debian-med.alieth.debian.org/tasks/>). A *blend* for scientific pursuits (in different fields) exists and can be researched at <http://wiki.debian.org/DebianScience>. Similar distros exist for almost every field discussed in this article, and needless to say, we shall limit ourselves to only mentioning the names of such distro along with relevant links.

2.1 Open Source for the medical profession

There are a host of applications for doctors, hospital employees and all those involved in the medical field including pharmacists and medical transcriptionists as well as other medical professionals.

2.1.1 Electronic medical/health recording software

Managing patient records is a major task for any medical practitioner / hospital, not just for financial reasons, but also to readily access the medical history of patients, or to identify any trends in diseases among the population, etc.

Most of the applications in this category are web services, which means that the code needs to be installed on some webserver before it can be used. The advantage is that, if installed on a online webhost, this allows the data to be accessed with a browser from any net connected device.

A category of software catering to electronic medical records, electronic health records and practice management software has evolved

OpenEMR (www.oemr.org)

OpenEMR is an open source electronic medical record (EMR) web service. This is written in PHP and requires a web server such as Apache running MySQL in the back end. The installation is slightly complex and requires some prior exposure to installing similar applications on a web server. However, once done, the application shows potential. Every aspect of a patient's health status, and details of the interaction with the medical service provider can be recorded. Accessing the